

CONVERSATION GUIDE FOR MANAGERS

Understanding what drives results



A light structure for the conversation that turns your team's results into shared understanding, and then into one agreed step.

🔍 Be curious

🗣️ Listen before deciding

👥 Share ownership

FILL IN BEFORE THE MEETING

📄 SURVEY

👥 TEAM

📅 DATE

Suggested agenda at a glance

Five steps, about 35 to 45 minutes in total. The pages after this one follow the same five steps and give the guidance for each.

1

Open the conversation

Set the purpose and create a safe environment.

5 min

2

Look at the overall results and select a focus area

Present the overall picture and the three focus areas, check resonance and choose one together.

5 to 10 min

3

Take a moment to celebrate

If there is a celebration point, notice what is going well and make it visible.

5 min

4

Dive deeper and set concrete agreements

Use the conversation starters to understand the selected area, then agree a realistic step.

15 to 20 min

5

Close off the meeting

Summarise what you heard, what happens next and the follow up moment.

3 min

Let's start!



Overall results and focus areas

Open the discussion by looking at the team's overall results. Use whichever visual supports the conversation best: this guide, a one pager, a slide deck or another results view. The aim is to create a shared picture before discussing the focus areas.

Three focus areas from your team results

1

2

3

Present all three, check what resonates, then choose one together. You guide the selection, but do not decide in isolation.

Celebration point, if available

Notice what is working well, and how the team can protect or build on it.

1

2

3

Opening, selecting, celebrating

Use these prompts as a light reference. Adapt them to the flow of the conversation rather than reading them as a script.

→ **One conversation, one focus area.** Present all three, check what resonates, then explore one together. Covering all three in one meeting leaves nothing decided.

1 Open the conversation

Set the purpose: understand the experience behind the results before deciding what to do. Create safety by agreeing to listen to understand, making room for different experiences, and discussing patterns rather than individual responses.

CONVERSATION STARTER

"These results tell us where to look, not why they are what they are. I would like us to understand the experience behind them together."

2 Look at the overall results and select a focus area

Present the overall picture first, then the three focus areas. Check whether they resonate, and guide the team to select one area to explore further.

OPEN THE PICTURE

What do you recognise in this picture?

CHECK RESONANCE

What feels incomplete or surprising? Which focus area is most useful for us to explore?

3 Take a moment to celebrate

If a celebration point is available, use it to make the team's contribution visible. Share a few concrete examples of behaviour you see day to day, without turning the moment into a speech.

NOTICE

What is helping this work well? When have you experienced this at its best?

BUILD

What should we protect, repeat or build on?

NOTES FROM STEPS 1 TO 3

Dive deeper into the selected focus area

Choose two or three starters, listen to the responses, ask a follow up where useful, check whether others recognise the pattern, and summarise what you hear.

STARTER	USE IT TO EXPLORE
Notice	What stands out to you about this result?
Example	What does this look like in our day to day work? Can you think of a recent example?
Context	What was happening when the survey was answered? Was there a project, change, deadline or period of pressure that may have influenced the result?
Driver	What seems to be making this easier or harder?
Difference	Does anyone experience this differently? What might explain the difference?
Influence	What part of this is within our team's influence, and what needs support elsewhere?
Meaningful change	What would make a meaningful difference?



KEEP LISTENING

"Can you say a little more?"

"What else is important here?"

"I am hearing ... Did I capture that accurately?"

Go deeper only if the team wants to.



WHAT I'M HEARING: PATTERNS AND EXAMPLES

Set concrete agreements

Agree whether to  **IMPROVE**,  **MONITOR** or  **NEED SUPPORT**, then set one small, realistic step. You remain accountable for the follow through.

 **SHARED FOCUS**

 **WHAT WE LEARNED**

 **FIRST STEP, ONE SMALL AND REALISTIC ACTION**

 **OWNER AND TIMING**

 **SUPPORT NEEDED**

 **FOLLOW UP MOMENT**

5

Close off the meeting

 **SUMMARISE AND CLOSE**

"Today we heard ... We agreed to ... The first step is ... [name] will ... by ..."

"What is the most important thing we should take forward?"

Thank everyone for participating and being open. Make sure the agreement and the follow up moment are visible to the team after the meeting.